

Letter Sound 'a'

Week 1 – Tuesday

Objective

Learn and practise letter / sound a.

Revise

Recall 's' using flashcards.

Teach 10mins

- **Hear Phonemes** - Share 3 images or objects beginning with phoneme a (ant apple astronaut). Say aloud, with emphasis on initial letter. What can the children hear? Model phoneme 'a' (short sound).
- **Teach grapheme and alliteration caption** 'a' amazing apple.
- **Lowercase formation caption:** All the way round, up and down.
- **Formation of grapheme** - Trace a in the air.
- Look at objects with letter a.
- **Vowel** - Explain that the letter 'a' is a vowel and it's the first one out of five vowels that the children will learn. Vowels are in all words that we read and write.
- **High Frequency Word** - a.
- **Common Exception Word** - as
Explain that 's' makes a /z/ sound.

Practise 10mins

Model action and caption as children practise forming the letter. How does it feel? (try it with right hand then with left hand)
Write 'a' with magic finger in the air or trace on a partner's back.
Give out whiteboards or paper and practise writing the formation.

Apply 5mins

Blending for Reading - Musical Statues

When the music stops show the children a letter flashcard; they have to make the phoneme and do the action/trace in the air.

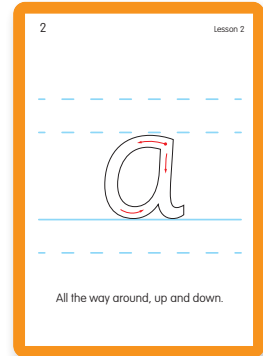
End of Session

Sing 'The Ants Go Marching'.
Read 'Avocado Baby' by John Burningham.
Draw 'a' in a variety of sizes and media, for example using chalk to draw on the ground.
Make grapheme with playdough.
Sort objects/pictures which start with 'a' or 's' and distinguish between the two.

Resources



Phonemic Awareness Cards
JNL691



Grapheme to Phoneme Cards
JNL686



Common Exception Word Cards
JNL687



High Frequency Word Cards
JNL688

The Ants Go Marching Song

The ants go marching one by one

Hurrah, hurrah

The ants go marching one by one

Hurrah, hurrah

The ants go marching one by one

The little one stops to suck his thumb

And they all go marching down to the ground

To get out of the rain

Boom, boom, boom

The little one stops to tie his shoe

The little one stops to climb a tree

The little one stops to shut the door

The little one stops to take a dive

The little one stops to pick up sticks

The little one stops to roller skate

The little one stops to check the time

The little one stops to shout, "The End!"

